

State of *Reinvention*

The Four Rooms of the Modern Woman

BODY

FAMILY

VOICE

WORK

2026 · THE MOMUMENTAL REPORT

Erika Hanafin Austria

FOUNDER, MOMUMENTAL MOMENTS® · PUBLISHER, MOMUMENTAL REINVENTION · CO-FOUNDER, NEON ID
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The Numbers Behind the *Rebuild*

Seven findings that explain why reinvention is not a personal crisis. It is the defining condition of a woman's midlife, and a rising economy.

87%

Body

of women with menopause symptoms never seek medical care, most never taught what is happening to them.

MIDI HEALTH SYNTHESIS, 2026

\$26.6B

Body

the annual US cost of menopause symptoms once lost work and medical costs are counted.

MAYO CLINIC PROCEEDINGS, 2023

~69%

Family

of divorces are filed by women. After a gray divorce a woman's standard of living drops 45%, versus 21% for men.

ROSENFELD, STANFORD, 2024 · LIN & BROWN, 2020

4X

Voice

more likely to die over ten years: women who consistently silenced themselves in conflict, versus women who spoke up.

FRAMINGHAM OFFSPRING STUDY, 2007

\$3.3T

Work

in revenue from 14.5 million women-owned US businesses, now growing faster than men-owned firms on every metric.

WELLS FARGO IMPACT OF WOMEN-OWNED BUSINESSES, 2025

2.3%

Work

the share of venture capital that goes to all-women founding teams. Mothers still earn 61.8 cents to a father's dollar.

FOUNDERS FORUM, 2025 · IWPR, 2025

No one hands you a map for all of it *at once*.

When I published the first State of the Union two years ago, I wrote it as a CEO documenting the resilience of mothers in business. Everything I said then was true. It was also only one room of the house.

Since then my own life did what the data in these pages describes. My body started changing in my mid-thirties, a decade before any book said it should. My marriage ended at thirty-eight. I was rebuilding my voice and my company at the same time I was raising four boys and trying to understand a body that no longer felt like mine. I did not go through those things in a tidy sequence. I went through them in the same season, all at once, with no one handing me a plan.

That is the difference in this report. Reinvention is not a single event you survive and move past. It is four rooms a woman is often living in at the same time: the Body that changes without

permission, the Family she rebuilds after it breaks, the Voice she stops apologizing for, and the Work she builds in the margins the world left her. This is the State of Reinvention, and the numbers are staggering, hopeful, and long overdue.

I built HeyMama and led it through an acquisition. I co-founded NEON ID to study how we show up. And I built The PHASE™ because I needed the tools in my own hands before anyone would put them there. What I know now is that the woman coming apart in her forties is not falling behind. She is the first person in her life brave enough to stop pretending.

The stats that follow prove the cost. They also prove the agency. Read them as evidence of what you already feel: you are not the exception. You are the majority, and the future being built is yours.

MOMumentally,
Erika Hanafin Austria

FOUNDER, MOMUMENTAL MOMENTS® · FORMER CEO, HEYMAMA · CO-FOUNDER, NEON ID
WWW.MOMUMENTALREINVENTION.COM



You are not in a phase.

You are in The PHASE™.

WHY A STATE OF REINVENTION, AND WHY NOW.

For most of a woman's life she is told that the hard seasons are detours. That the exhaustion is temporary, the body is misbehaving, the marriage is her failure to manage, the self-doubt is hers to fix quietly. She is told to get back to normal.

The data says otherwise. What we have been calling personal crisis is, at scale, the ordinary architecture of the modern female midlife. More than half of women aged 30 to 35 already report moderate to severe perimenopause symptoms. Women file the majority of divorces and pay the steepest price for choosing themselves. They are interrupted at the Supreme Court and dismissed in the exam room. And they are opening businesses faster than any other group in America while capturing barely two percent of the capital.

Put those truths in one place and a pattern appears. Reinvention is not the breakdown. It is the redesign. It happens in four rooms, and a woman is usually standing in more than one of them at the same time.

 Body The change that arrives without asking.	 Family The household she rebuilds on purpose.
 Voice The sentence she finally says out loud.	 Work The empire built in the margins.

This report walks through all four, with the numbers, the cost, and the reason each one is a doorway and not a dead end.

BODY | FAMILY | VOICE | WORK

ROOM ONE

The Body

*The body keeps the score before the calendar does.
Reinvention rarely begins as a choice. It begins as a
symptom no one will name.*

PERIMENOPAUSE · HORMONES · MIDLIFE HEALTH

The change arrives a decade early, and almost *no one is ready*.

The average American woman reaches menopause at 51. The symptomatic runway begins as much as a decade earlier, which means many women are inside the transition in their late thirties and early forties and never name it. A 2025 study found that more than half of women aged 30 to 35, and nearly two thirds aged 36 to 40, already report moderate to severe perimenopause symptoms. About 1.3 million US women reach menopause every year, roughly six thousand a day.

II to I2%

of women begin the transition before age 41, often misread as stress or burnout.

NATURE, 2023

~80%

of midlife women experience one or more menopause symptoms.

MAYO CLINIC PROCEEDINGS, 2025

The symptoms are rarely dramatic. That is what makes them dangerous. It is the volume turned down on your own life, one notch at a time, easy to blame on cortisol and a full calendar.

The care gap is real, and it is *not in your head*.

Here is what turns a normal transition into a silent emergency. Nearly nine in ten women with symptoms never seek care. Only about 31 percent of OB-GYN residency programs teach a standardized menopause curriculum, even though 93 percent of residents say one should exist. And 94 percent of women report no menopause education in school. Most women are left to self-diagnose in real time, then are dismissed when they ask.

\$26.6B

annual US cost of menopause symptoms, including \$1.8B in lost work time alone.

MAYO CLINIC PROCEEDINGS, 2023

\$24.4B

projected size of the global menopause market by 2030, up from \$18.7B in 2025.

GRAND VIEW RESEARCH, 2025

WHO IS CHANGING THIS ROOM

Dr. Mary Claire Haver, author of the 2024 bestseller *The New Menopause*, turned menopause science into plain language for millions. Halle Berry launched Respin Health in 2025 and became a leading public face of midlife care. Midi Health and Maven are building the insurance-covered clinical care most women were never offered.

The PHASE™ **Body room** is the workbook for this exact season. It names the labs to request and the words to advocate for yourself.

[THEPHASE.CO/SERIES](https://thephase.co/series)

ROOM TWO

The Family

This is where the myth of the broken home goes to die. The data proves the cost. It also proves the agency.

DIVORCE · CO-PARENTING · BLENDED & SOLO MOTHERHOOD

Look at *who is choosing it.*

Every headline frames divorce as something that happens to a woman. The data says she is usually the one deciding. Women file roughly 69 percent of divorces, and the median woman now divorces at almost 41, squarely in midlife. The fastest growing group of divorced adults is people over 50: gray divorce among those 65 and older has tripled since 1990. These are not women falling apart. They are women who spent decades carrying the household and decided the arrangement no longer worked.

45%

drop in a woman's standard of living after gray divorce, versus 21% for men.

LIN & BROWN, 2020

71%

of the household mental load is carried by mothers, the invisible work of planning and remembering.

JOURNAL OF MARRIAGE AND FAMILY, 2024

Gray divorce is not a family falling apart. It is, disproportionately, a woman deciding the arrangement no longer works and building a truer one, even knowing the financial cliff is real.

The cost is real. So is *the rebuild.*

The financial picture is honest and hard. Single-mother families face a poverty rate of 31.3 percent, nearly six times the rate for married couples, and roughly 80 percent of custodial parents are mothers. Only 20 percent of women repartner after a gray divorce, compared with 31 percent of men. Women more often rebuild the household, and rebuild it alone. The reinvention is not pretending the cost away. It is making the invisible labor visible, valued, and finally hers to allocate.

17%

of US children live in a blended family, about 1 in 6.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER, 2026

2.5X

the hours women spend on unpaid care and domestic work compared to men, worldwide.

UN WOMEN, 2025

WHO IS CHANGING THIS ROOM

Dr. Susan L. Brown of Bowling Green State University is the leading academic voice on gray divorce. OurFamilyWizard turned co-parenting logistics into a documented, lower-conflict system. Kate Anthony, author of *The D Word*, coaches women through the decision to leave and rebuild.

The **Co-Parenting Power Method®** turns the wreckage narrative into an operating system for the family you design on purpose.

ROOM THREE

The Voice

The most expensive thing a woman owns is the sentence she did not say. In this room, reinvention stops being a metaphor and becomes measurable.

CONFIDENCE · SELF-TRUST · BEING BELIEVED

The swallowed sentence has *a body count*.

For decades women were rewarded for editing themselves. Likeable, agreeable, not too much. The research now shows what that costs. Women who consistently silenced themselves during marital conflict were four times more likely to die over a ten year follow-up than women who spoke up, even after adjusting for the usual risk factors. In midlife women, higher self-silencing tracks with measurable plaque buildup in the arteries. Voice is not a soft skill. It is tied to survival.

39.4%

of women seen for pelvic pain said a provider made them feel “crazy.”

JAMA NETWORK OPEN, 2025

10 to 11 yrs

average wait for an endometriosis or adenomyosis diagnosis.

JOURNAL OF WOMEN'S HEALTH, 2026

The un-pushed-back-on symptom becomes a ten-year diagnostic delay. The un-applied-for role becomes a career that stalled at 100 percent qualified. Reinvention is finally using the voice that was always there.

The double bind, *and the turn*.

Women are interrupted 33 percent more often than men, and female Supreme Court justices are cut off roughly three times as often as their male colleagues. Robes and lifetime appointments do not close the gap. Three in four women executives report imposter feelings. And women still self-authorize less: the widely cited finding is that women apply for a role when they meet 100 percent of the qualifications, while men apply at about 60. Then comes the turn. In a 2026 survey, 77 percent of women over 50 said they had reached a point where they no longer worry what others think, and 75 percent now trust their instincts over seeking approval.

WHO IS CHANGING THIS ROOM

Katty Kay and Claire Shipman, authors of *The Confidence Code*, made the confidence gap mainstream and argued it is buildable. Mary Ann Sieghart, author of *The Authority Gap*, documented with data how women are still taken less seriously. Dr. Mary Claire Haver became the face of “you are not crazy, you are not alone” in women's health.

The **Voice room** of The PHASE™ is where you come back to your own voice and trust your no.

[THEPHASE.CO/VOL/SELF-TRUST](https://thephase.co/vol/self-trust)



ROOM FOUR

The Work

*Women are the fastest growing force in American business,
and they are doing it against the current.*

MOMPREENEURS · ECONOMICS · BUILDING THROUGH IT

WV

The fastest growth in the economy, built *in the margins*.

Women now own 14.5 million US businesses, nearly 4 in 10 of all firms, generating 3.3 trillion dollars in revenue, up from 2.7 trillion just a couple of years ago. From 2019 to 2024 women-owned firms grew faster than men-owned firms on every metric that matters: 17 percent more firms, nearly 20 percent more jobs, and almost 54 percent more revenue. Mothers are the fastest growing engine inside that number. This is not leaning in. It is rebuilding a machine that was never designed for a mother to run.

\$10.2T

the revenue women-owned firms would add if they matched men-owned averages. Parity is 120 years away at the current pace.

WELLS FARGO, 2025

61.8¢

what mothers earn per father's dollar. Black mothers 48.8¢, Latina mothers 42.7¢.

IWPR, 2025

Women own 39 percent of the businesses and receive 2 percent of the funding. That math is not a footnote. That math is the reinvention.

The cost shows up in *the body*, again.

The pressure is not free. In 2025, 68 percent of women reported feeling burned out, compared with 42 percent of men. The share of mothers rating their own mental health as excellent fell from 38 percent in 2016 to 26 percent in 2023. The Work room and the Body room are the same story told twice: a woman carrying a system that was not built to hold her, and building anyway.

WHO IS CHANGING THIS ROOM

Emma Grede, co-founder of Good American and founding partner of SKIMS, built a multibillion dollar portfolio as a mother of four. Sara Blakely bootstrapped Spanx to a billion. Whitney Wolfe Herd took Bumble public and returned as CEO. Jessica Alba built The Honest Company from her own values as a new mom.

The **Work room, Building Through It**, is for the empire you build while you rebuild everything else.

THEPHASE.CO

The future is *MOMumental.*

Put the four rooms in one house and the thesis is undeniable. Reinvention is not a woman breaking down. It is a woman redesigning the whole thing at once: the body that changed without asking, the family she rebuilt on purpose, the voice she stopped apologizing for, and the work she built in the margins.

The reinvention economy is already here. It is the 24 billion dollar menopause market and the 3.3 trillion dollars women-owned businesses now generate. It is every woman who asked for the labs, filed the papers, said the sentence, and started the company. The market is simply catching up to what her body, her family, her voice, and her work already decided.

You are not the exception. You are the majority. And you are not falling apart.

*You are not falling apart. You are becoming
MOMumental.*

ERIKA HANAFIN AUSTRIA · MOMUMENTALREINVENTION.COM

The Four Rooms of *The PHASE™*

Every room in this report has a tool. The PHASE™ is the whole season of rebuilding, organized so you can start in the room you are standing in right now.



Body · The PHASE™ Perimenopause, Vol I to V

Symptoms, hormones, labs, self-advocacy, and rebuilding.

[THEPHASE.CO/SERIES](https://thephase.co/series)

\$27^{ea}



Family · The Co-Parenting Power Method®

The operating system for the family you design on purpose after divorce.

[THEPHASE.CO](https://thephase.co)

\$47



Voice · Self-Trust and Confidence

Coming back to your own voice and trusting your no.

[THEPHASE.CO/VOL/SELF-TRUST](https://thephase.co/vol/self-trust)

\$27



Work · Building Through It

Building the work and the empire while you rebuild everything else.

[THEPHASE.CO](https://thephase.co)

\$17

The PHASE™ Library

All four rooms, every tool, one permanent home. Always open.

[MOMUMENTALREINVENTION.COM/P/THE-LIBRARY](https://momumentalreinvention.com/p/the-library)

\$228

ONE PAYMENT · YOURS FOREVER

FREE EVERY TUESDAY: THE MOMUMENTAL REINVENTION LETTER AT [MOMUMENTALREINVENTION.COM](https://momumentalreinvention.com)

Sources

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- 02 **Institute for Women's Policy Research**, The Parenthood Pay Divide (May 2025, data 2023): mothers 61.8¢, Black mothers 48.8¢, Latina mothers 42.7¢ per father's dollar.
- 03 **Founders Forum**, Women in VC & Startup Funding 2025: all-women teams 2.3% of venture capital; women of color roughly 1%.
- 04 **Forbes** (Oct 2025) and **JAMA** (2025): 68% of women report burnout vs 42% of men; mothers rating mental health "excellent" fell 38.4% (2016) to 25.8% (2023).
- 05 **Mayo Clinic Proceedings** (Faubion et al., 2023): \$1.8B lost work time and \$26.6B total annual cost of menopause symptoms in the US.
- 06 **Midi Health synthesis** (2026): 87% never seek care; 31% of OB-GYN residencies teach menopause; 94% received no menopause education.
- 07 **Cunningham et al.**, npj Women's Health (2025): 55% of women aged 30 to 35 and 64% aged 36 to 40 report moderate to severe symptoms.
- 08 **Vatankhah et al.**, Nature (2023, via Paloma Health): 11 to 12% of women begin perimenopause before age 41.
- 09 **Mayo Clinic Proceedings** (2025): approximately 80% of midlife women experience one or more menopause symptoms.
- 10 **Grand View Research** (2025): global menopause market \$18.7B in 2025, projected \$24.4B by 2030.
- 11 **Michael Rosenfeld**, Stanford University (via Divorce.com, 2024): women initiate roughly 69% of divorces.
- 12 **Lin & Brown**, Journals of Gerontology Series B (2020): women's standard of living drops 45% after gray divorce vs 21% for men; 20% of women repartner vs 31% of men.
- 13 **NCFMR**, Bowling Green State University (Brown & Lin, 2024-2025): divorce among adults 65+ has tripled since 1990.
- 14 **US Census Bureau** (2022, 2024): median age at first divorce 40.7 for women; single-mother poverty 31.3%; roughly 80% of custodial parents are mothers.
- 15 **Weeks & Ruppanner**, Journal of Marriage and Family (2024): mothers manage 71% of household cognitive labor.
- 16 **Pew Research Center** (April 2026): 17% of US children live in a blended family. UN Women, Gender Snapshot 2025: women perform 2.5x the unpaid care work of men globally.
- 17 **Framingham Offspring Study** (Eaker et al., 2007): women who self-silenced in conflict were 4x more likely to die over 10 years. Annals of Behavioral Medicine (2021): self-silencing linked to carotid plaque in midlife women.
- 18 **JAMA Network Open** (2025): 39.4% of women seen for pelvic pain made to feel "crazy." Journal of Women's Health (2026): 10 to 11 year diagnostic delay for endometriosis and adenomyosis.
- 19 **KPMG** (2020): 75% of women executives report imposter feelings. George Washington University (2014) and Northwestern (2017): women interrupted 33% more; female Supreme Court justices interrupted about 3x as often.
- 20 **Harvard Business Review** (2014, oft-cited HP finding): women apply at 100% of qualifications, men at about 60%. OnePoll for Menopace (2026 survey, 1,000 women 50+): 77% no longer worry what others think; 75% trust their instincts over approval.